

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

The Words I Owe You

*A Journal for Parents Healing From Addiction
— To the Child You Couldn't Fully See*



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · for the words that are hard to say

WELCOME

Before You Begin



There are words you owe your child that are almost impossible to say out loud. Maybe the moment never comes. Maybe they won't take your calls. Maybe you've tried and the words broke apart in your mouth.

This journal is where those words finally get written — fully, honestly, without the addiction talking over you.

Fair warning, given with love: these pages will hurt. Facing what your addiction cost your child is some of the heaviest work a heart can do. Do it anyway. Slowly.

And please don't do it alone — a sponsor, counselor, or recovery group can hold you steady through these pages. This work IS recovery.

STARTING POINT

Who I'm Writing To



Write about your child — who they were during your addiction, who they are now, and where things stand between you today. Just the honest picture.

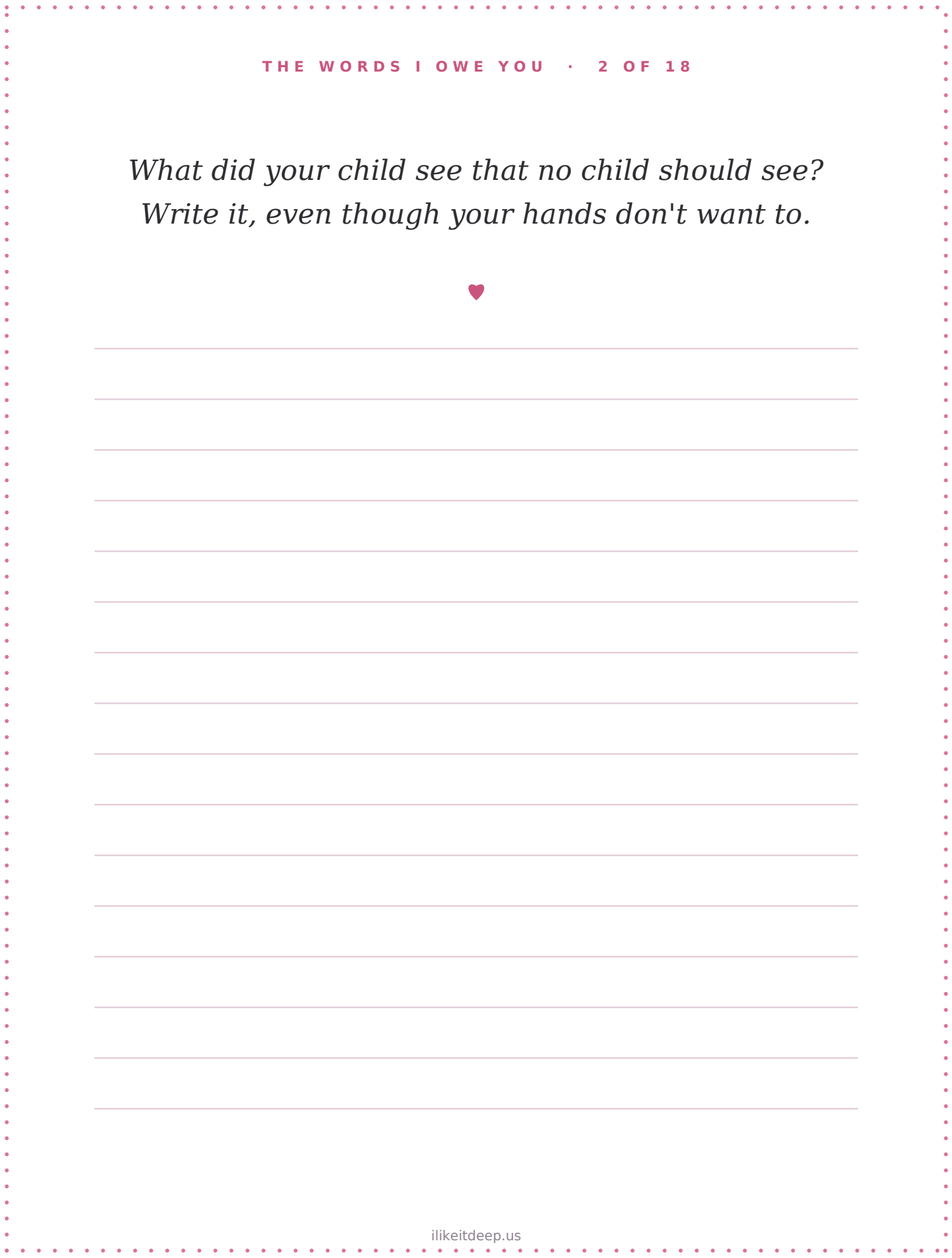
PART ONE

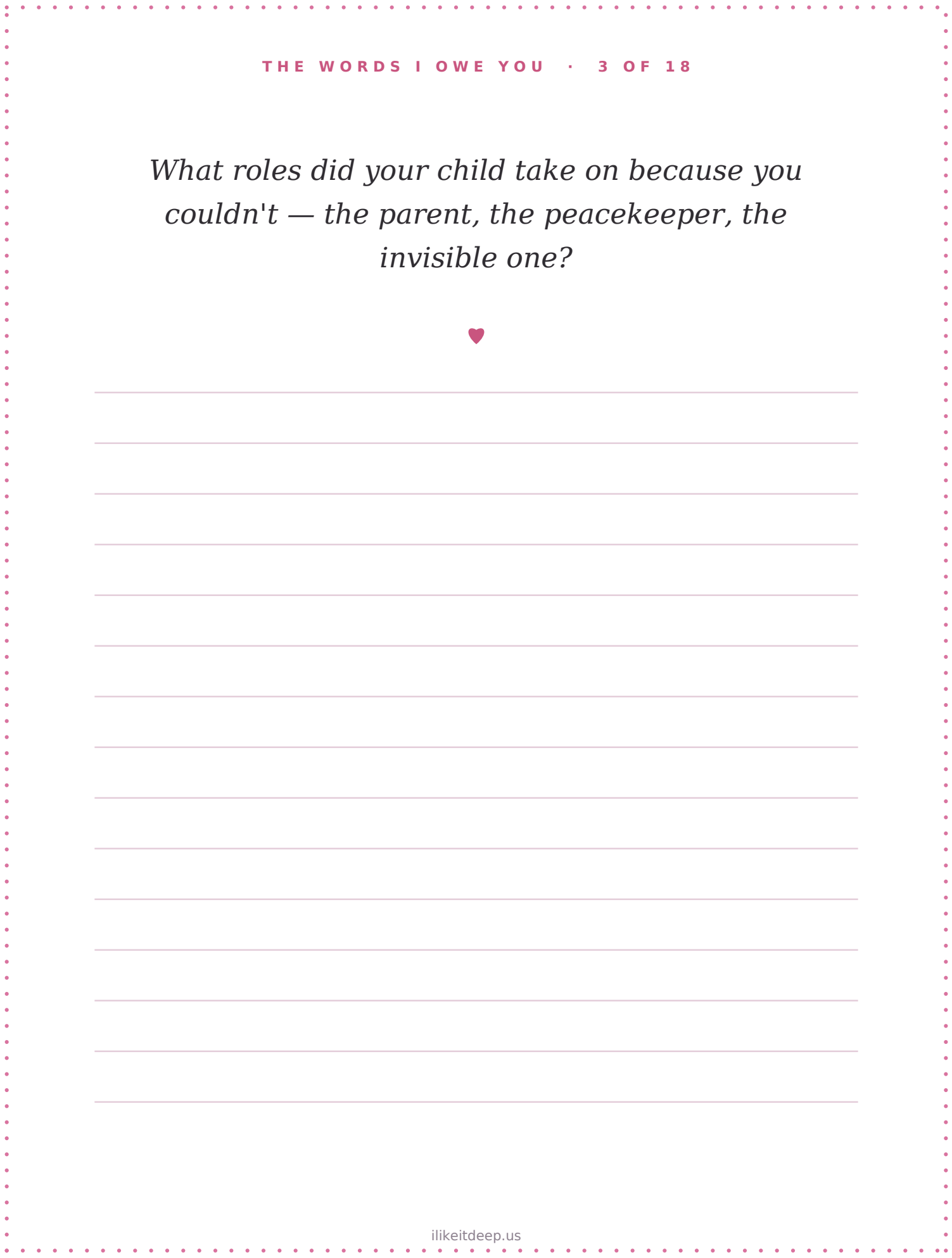
Facing What Happened



*Real amends start with real seeing. No
softening, no drowning — just truth.*

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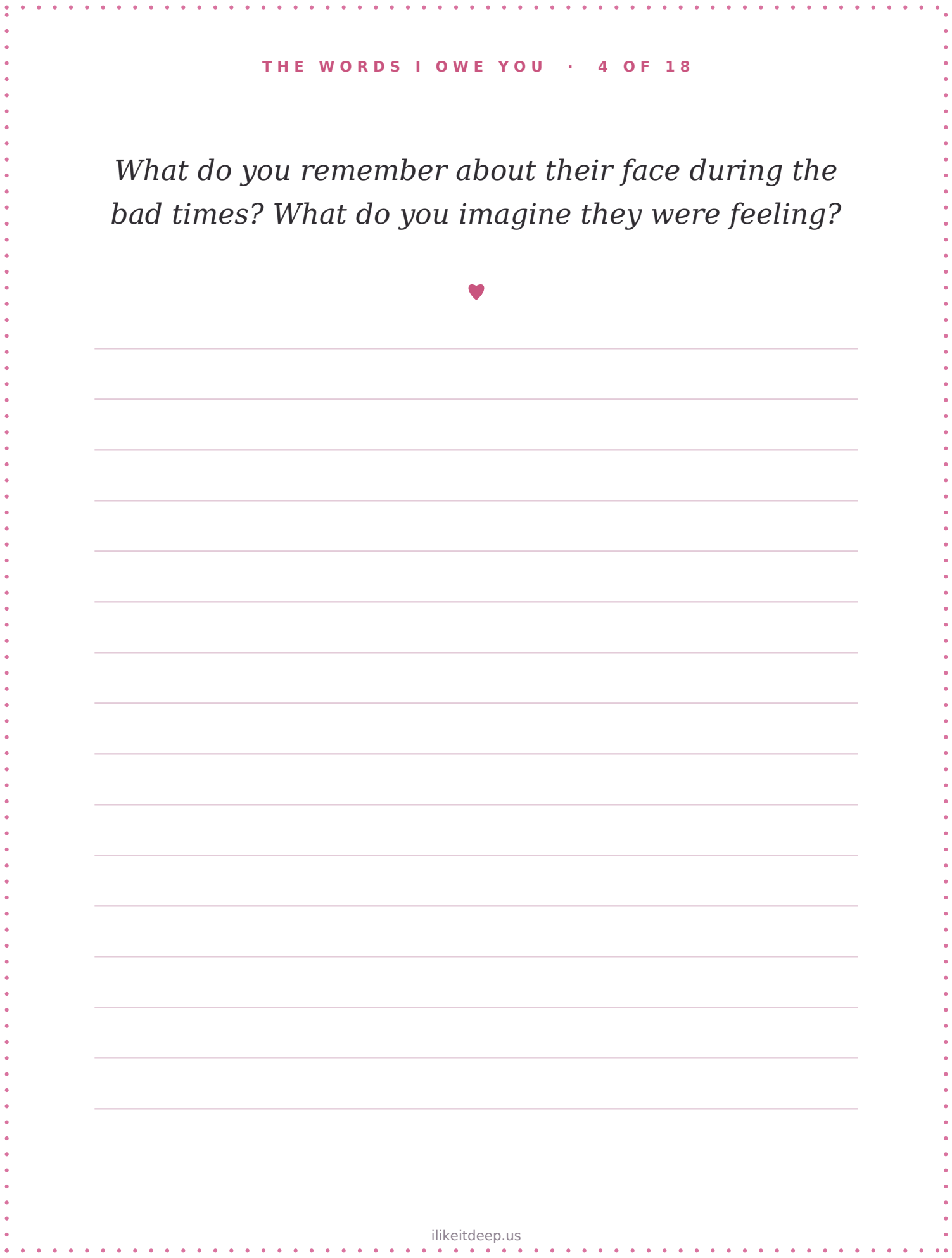
The image shows a worksheet page with a dotted border. At the top center, it says "THE WORDS I OWE YOU · 3 OF 18". Below this, there is a centered question in italics: "What roles did your child take on because you couldn't — the parent, the peacekeeper, the invisible one?". Underneath the question is a small red heart icon. The majority of the page is filled with horizontal lines for writing. At the bottom center, the website "ilikeitdeep.us" is printed.

THE WORDS I OWE YOU · 3 OF 18

*What roles did your child take on because you
couldn't — the parent, the peacekeeper, the
invisible one?*

A small red heart icon used as a decorative element or separator between the question and the writing area.

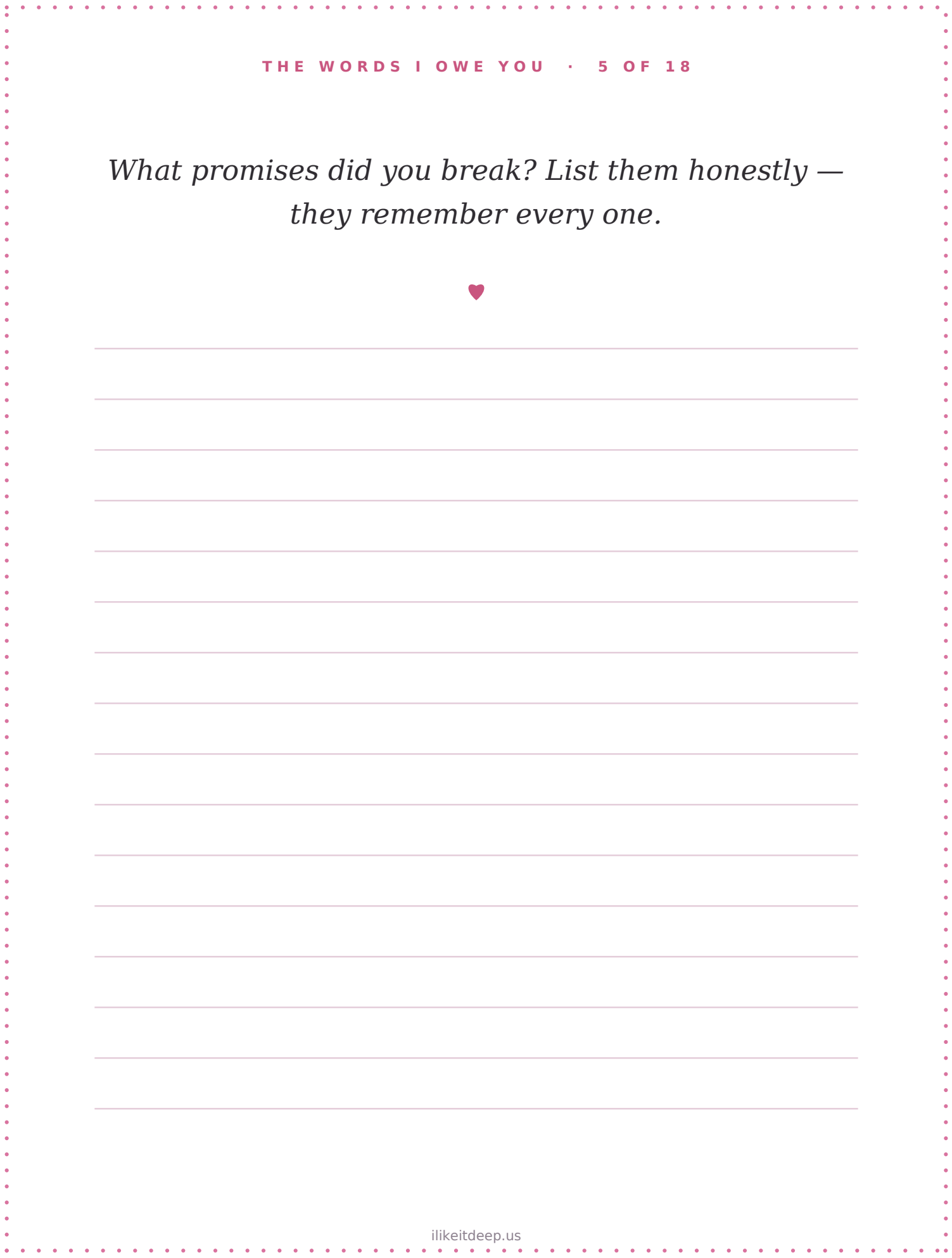
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[illegible][illegible]

THE WORDS I OWE YOU • 5 OF 18

*What promises did you break? List them honestly —
they remember every one.*

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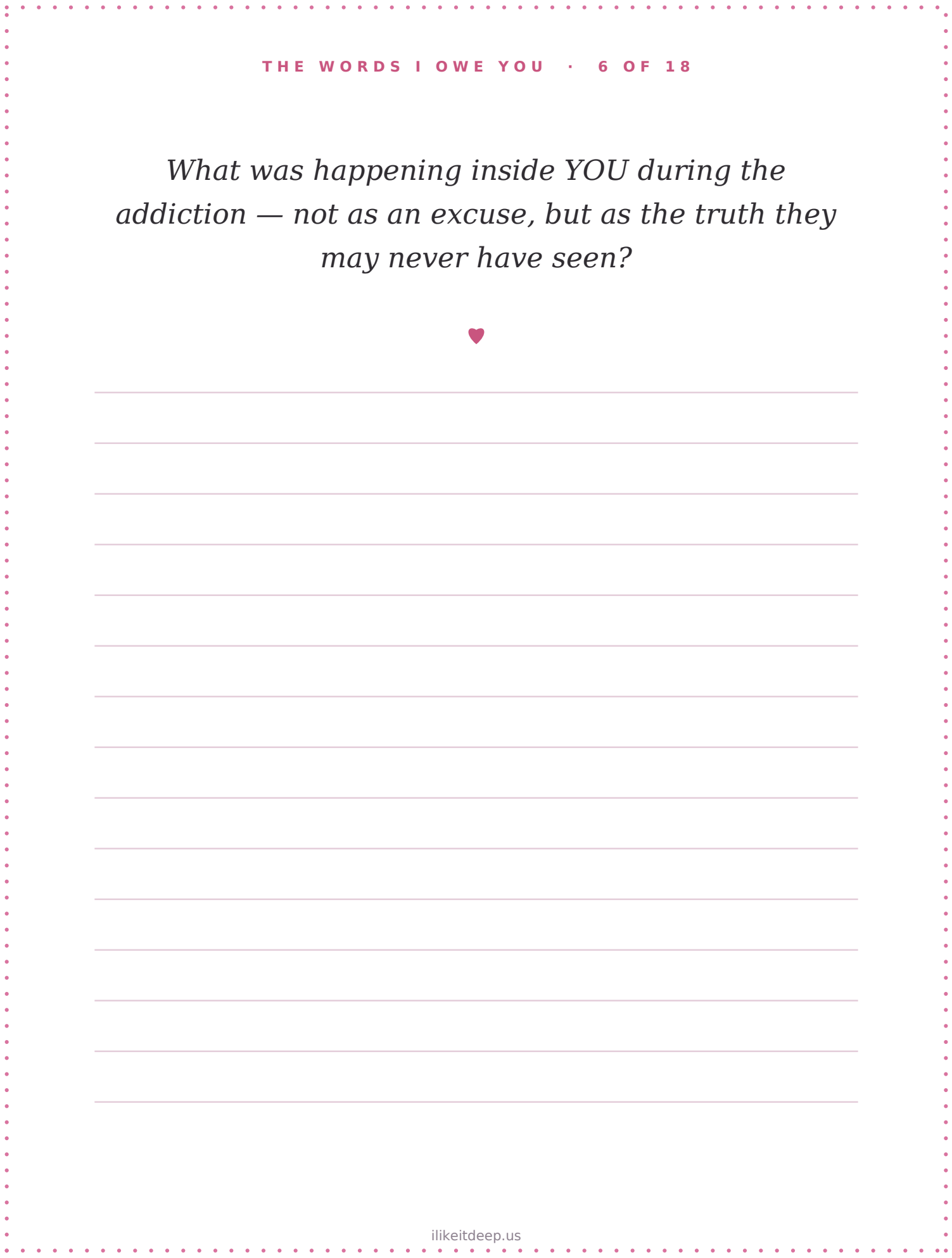
A decorative border made of small dots surrounds the entire page.

THE WORDS I OWE YOU • 5 OF 18

*What promises did you break? List them honestly —
they remember every one.*

A small red heart icon centered below the prompt.

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[illegible]

THE WORDS I OWE YOU • 6 OF 18

What was happening inside YOU during the addiction — not as an excuse, but as the truth they may never have seen?

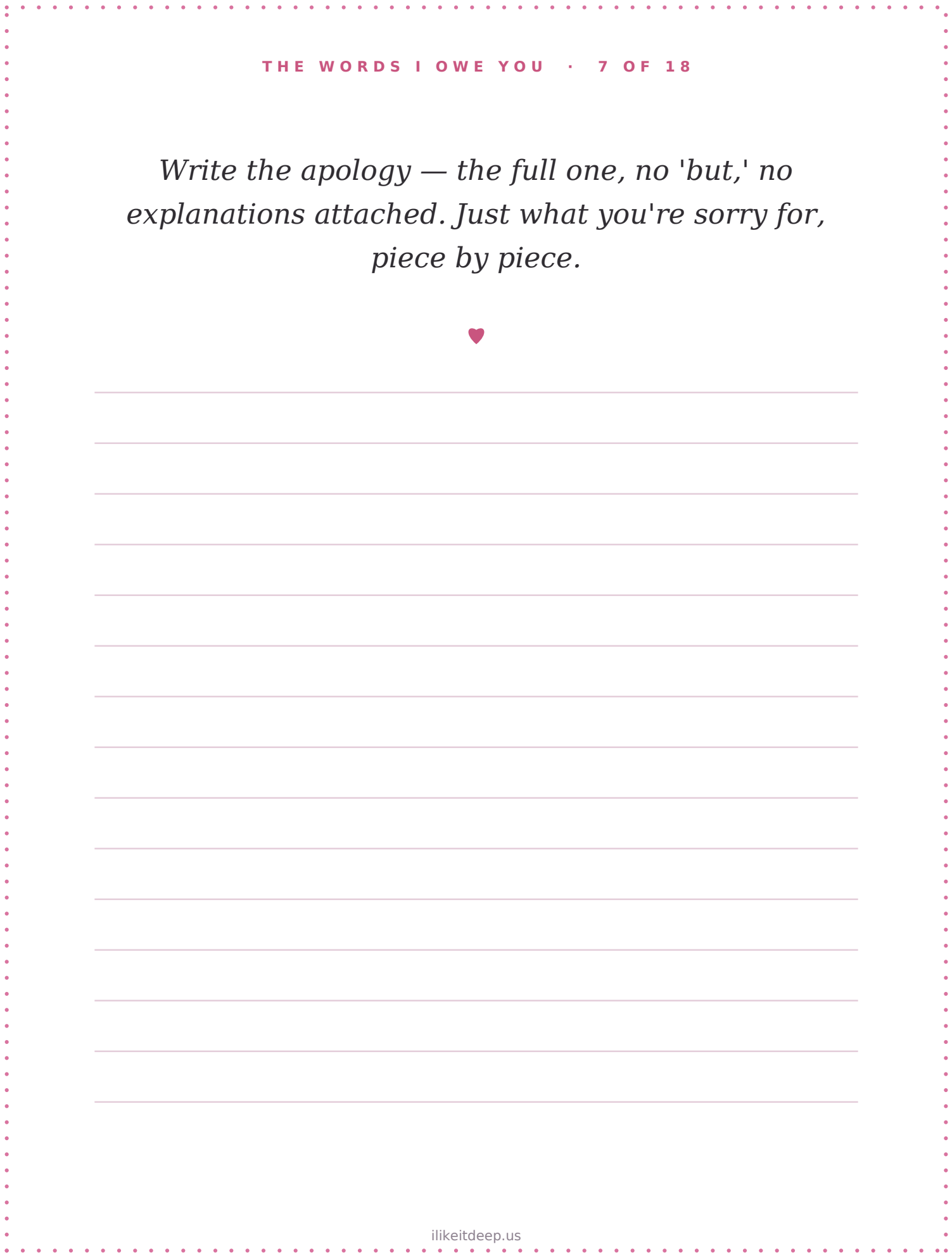
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PART TWO

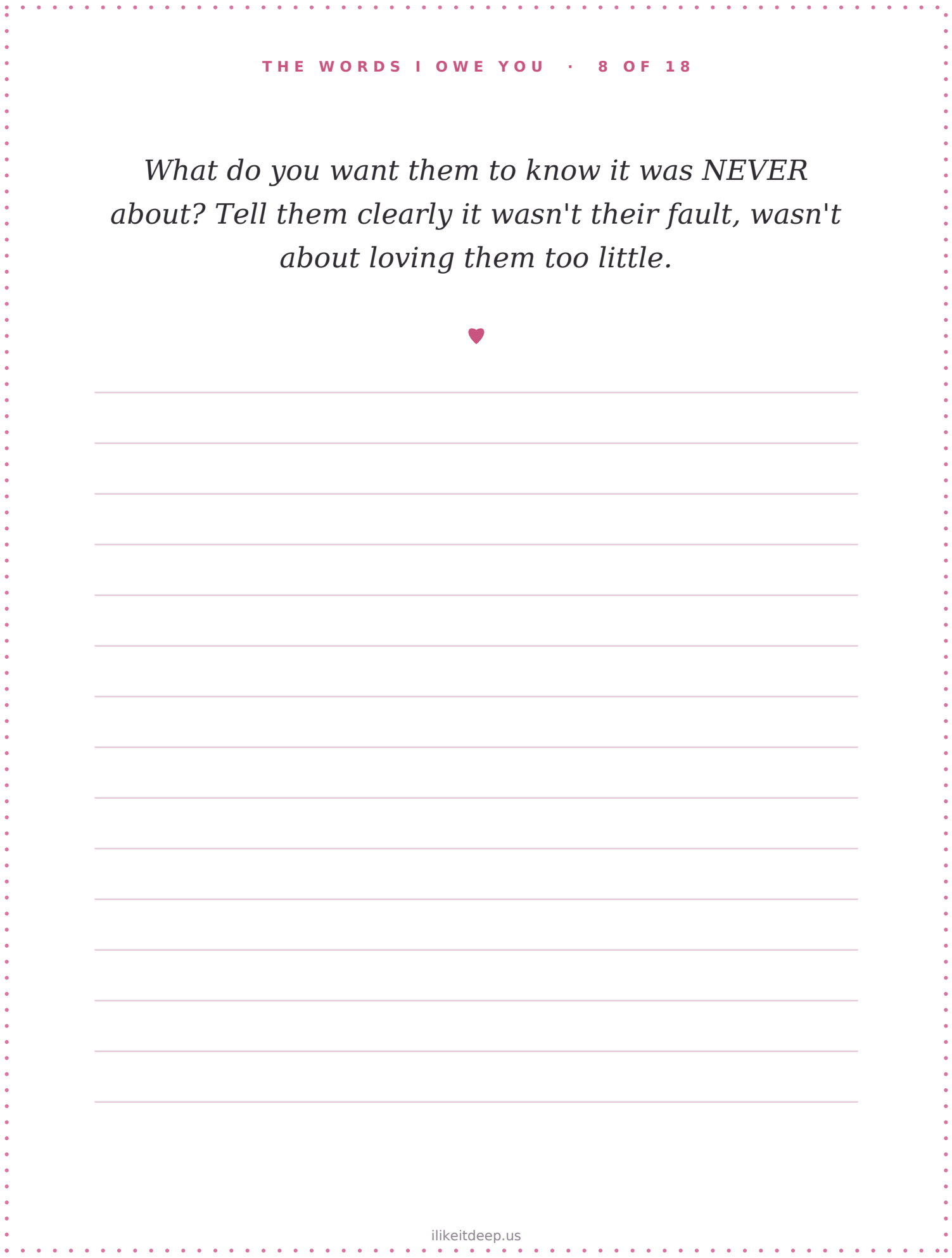
The Words You Owe



*Say it all here first. The page can hold what
the room couldn't.*

[illegible][illegible]

The image shows a worksheet with a light gray background and a decorative border of small pink dots. At the top center, the title "THE WORDS I OWE YOU · 8 OF 18" is written in a bold, pink, sans-serif font. Below the title, there is a paragraph of text in a black, italicized serif font: "What do you want them to know it was NEVER about? Tell them clearly it wasn't their fault, wasn't about loving them too little." Centered below this text is a small pink heart icon. The lower half of the page consists of approximately 20 horizontal pink lines, providing space for handwriting practice or additional notes.



The image shows a worksheet with a light gray background and a decorative border of small pink dots. At the top center, the title "THE WORDS I OWE YOU · 8 OF 18" is written in a bold, pink, sans-serif font. Below the title, there is a paragraph of text in a black, italicized serif font: "What do you want them to know it was NEVER about? Tell them clearly it wasn't their fault, wasn't about loving them too little." Centered below this text is a small pink heart icon. The lower half of the page is filled with horizontal pink lines for writing. At the very bottom center, the website address "ilikeitdeep.us" is printed in a small, black, sans-serif font.

THE WORDS I OWE YOU · 8 OF 18

*What do you want them to know it was NEVER
about? Tell them clearly it wasn't their fault, wasn't
about loving them too little.*

A small, solid pink heart icon centered on the page.

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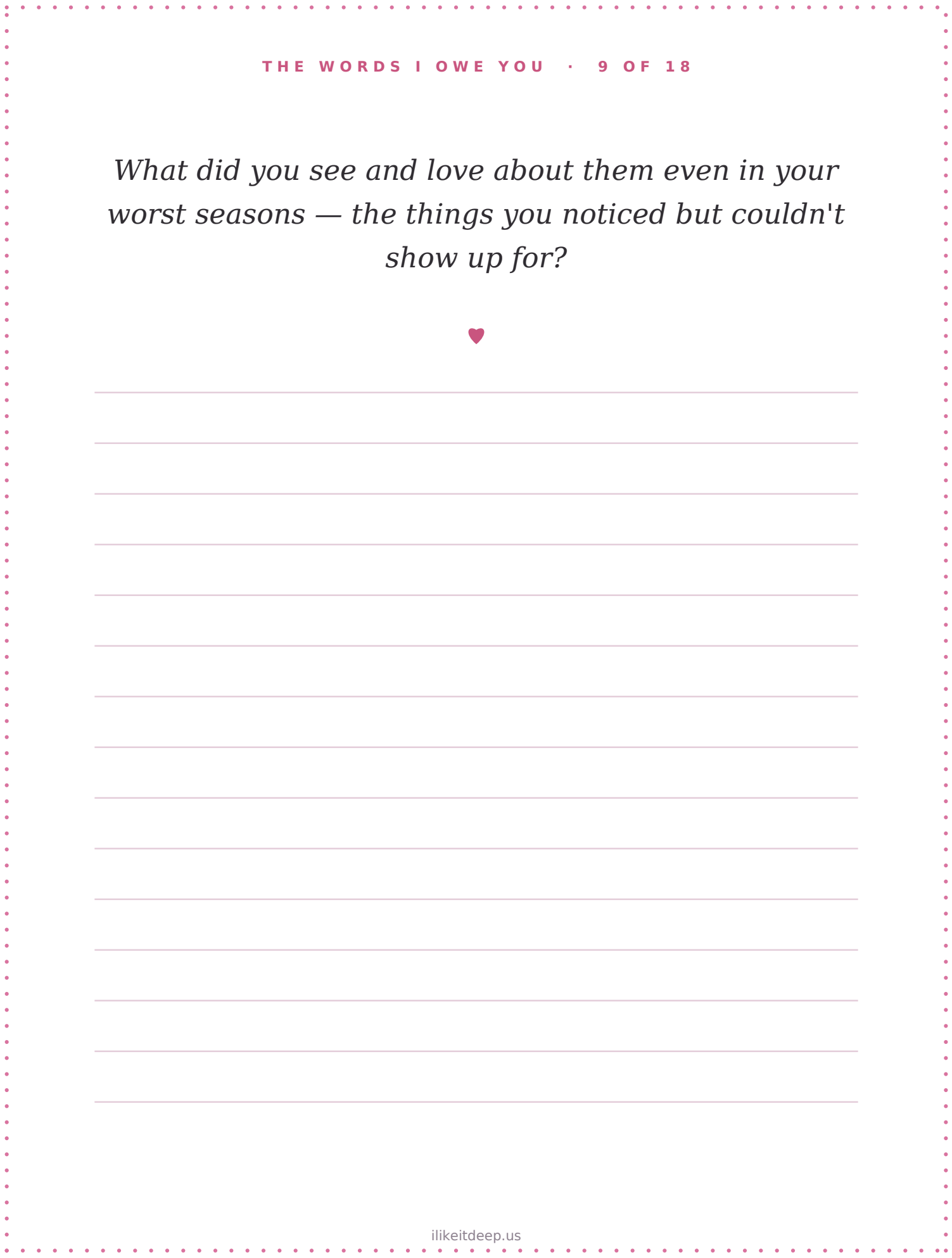
A decorative border made of small dots surrounds the entire page.

THE WORDS I OWE YOU • 9 OF 18

What did you see and love about them even in your worst seasons — the things you noticed but couldn't show up for?

A small red heart icon centered below the question.

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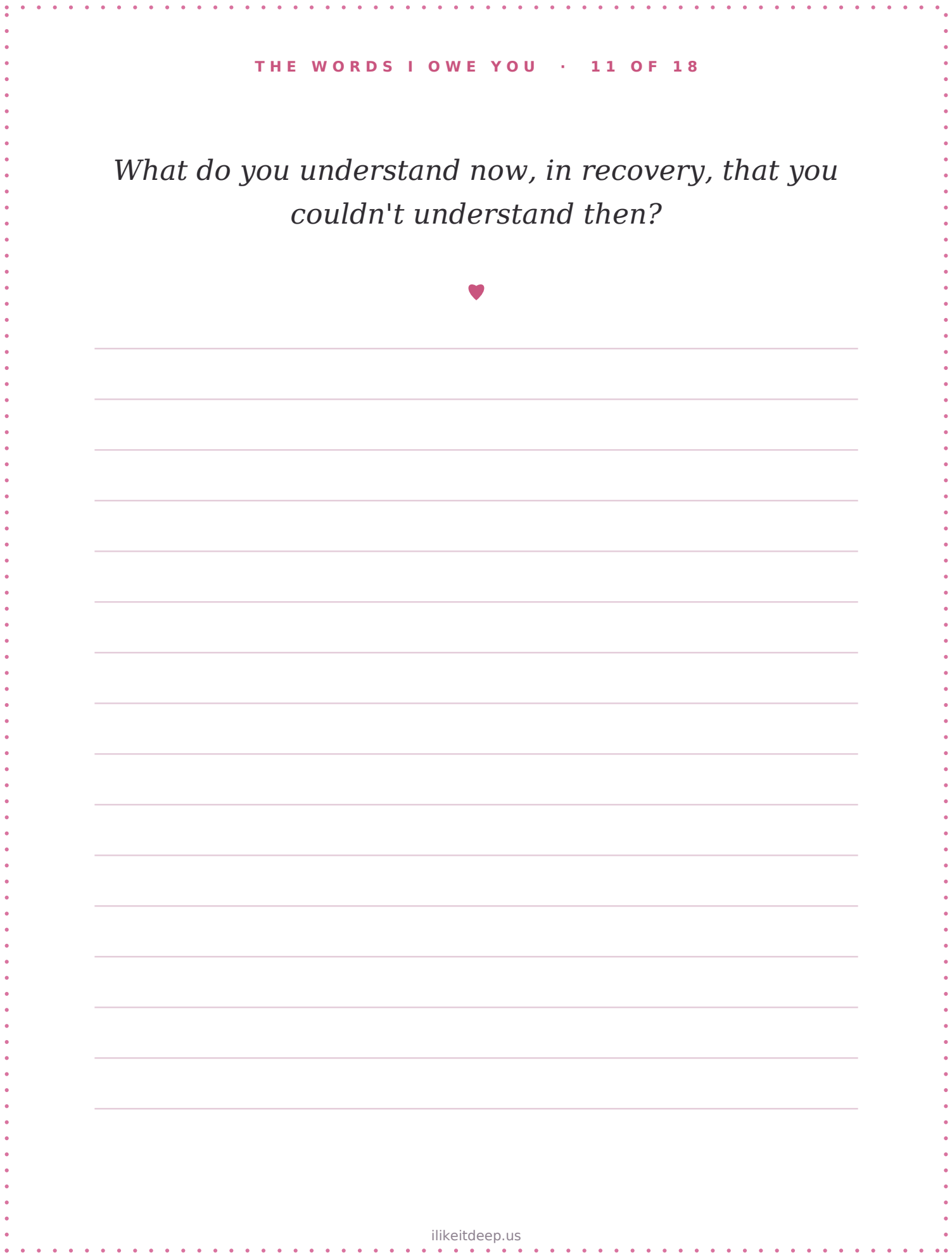
THE WORDS I OWE YOU • 9 OF 18

What did you see and love about them even in your worst seasons — the things you noticed but couldn't show up for?

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What do you wish you could go back and do — the games, the school nights, the moments? Walk through them here.



[illegible][illegible]

What are you NOT entitled to ask from them — forgiveness, trust, closeness — and can you say the words anyway, expecting nothing?



PART THREE

Showing Up Now



*Amends isn't a speech. It's how you live from
here — whether or not they're watching.*

What does 'living amends' look like for you — the daily proof that you're different, kept up with no audience?



If they've set boundaries or distance, what does respecting that fully look like — and can you honor it as part of your amends?

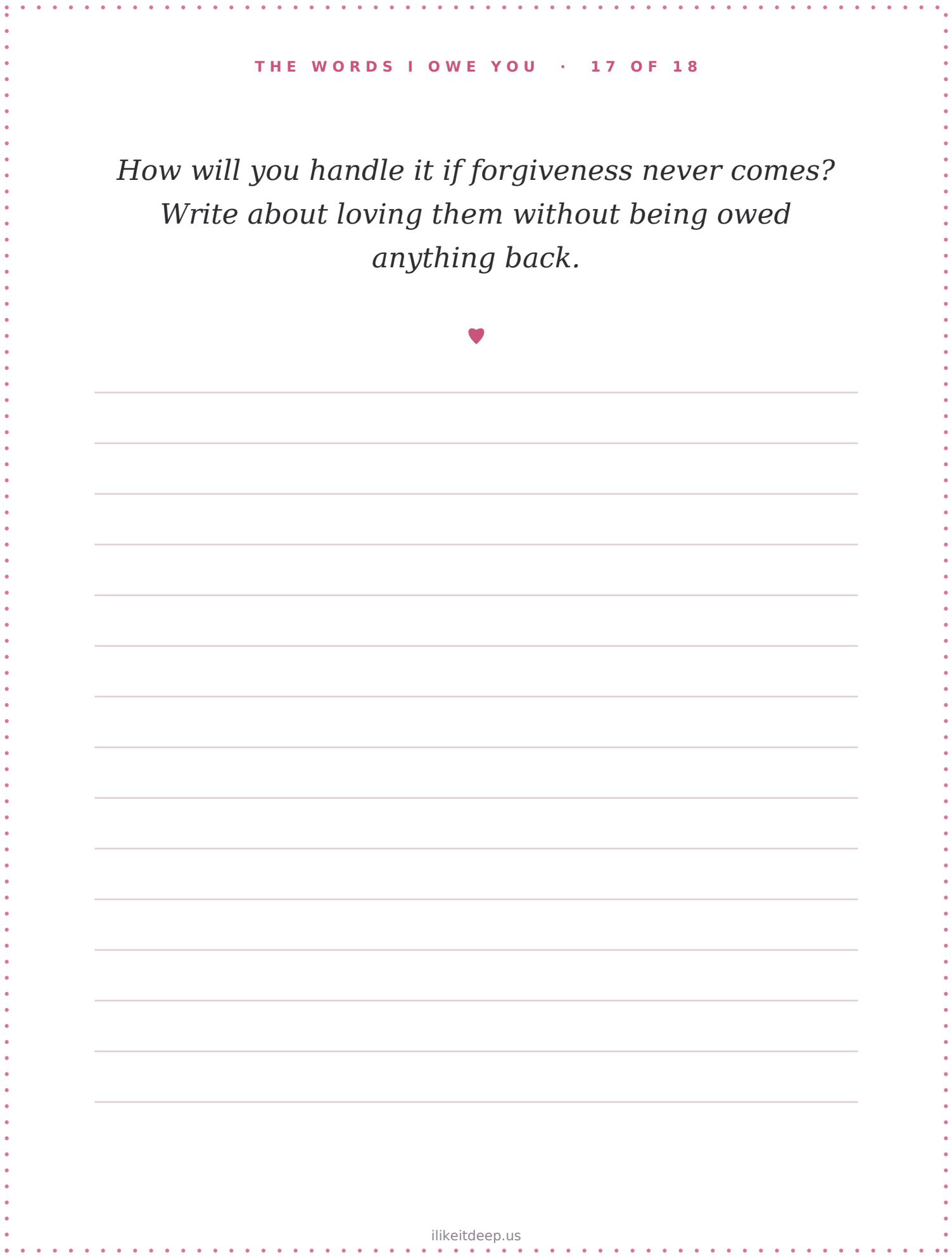


What kind of parent (or grandparent) do you want to be with whatever time and access you're given?



What will you do with these written words — share them someday if welcome, keep them as your truth, read them to a sponsor?



[illegible][illegible]

*Write one final letter: everything above, distilled.
The letter you'd want them to find someday.*



The Daily Proof



Amends is a behavior, repeated. Check the ones you commit to.

- ☐ Stay in my recovery today — that's amends item one, always
- ☐ Keep every promise I make this week, however small
- ☐ Respect their boundaries without negotiating or guilting
- ☐ Show up on time, sober, every time I'm given the chance
- ☐ Let them be angry without defending the past
- ☐ Say 'you're right, and I'm sorry' without adding 'but'
- ☐ Be consistent longer than feels fair
- ☐ Work these wounds with my sponsor or counselor, not on my child
- ☐ Love them out loud when allowed, and quietly when not
- ☐ Never make my healing their job

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

What I Want You to Know



Short truths for your child — one line at a time, added as they come to you. Someday these may be the page you share.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



You just did what active addiction never let you do:
you looked directly at the cost, and you didn't look away.

Whether your child ever reads these words or not,
writing them changed something real — in you,
and in what you'll do next.

Keep going in your recovery. Every sober, honest,
consistent day IS the apology, delivered again.

You can't rewrite their childhood. You can be
worth knowing now. That's the work. Stay in it.



*The apology they needed is the person
you're becoming.*



ilikeitdeep.us · stay deep